Software Requirements Specification

BashaMate: A Housing & Roommate Finder Platform for Bachelor Students

Part 1: Introduction

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This Software Requirements Specification (SRS) document describes the functional and non-functional requirements for BashaMate, a web-based platform that helps bachelor (unmarried) students find rental housing and compatible roommates. It defines what the system will do and how it is expected to perform, and serves as the foundation for design, development, and testing of the product.

1.2 Intended Audience

This document is intended for the development team (frontend and backend developers), the course instructor/evaluator, and the project group members responsible for testing and demonstrating the system. It may also be referenced by future contributors extending the platform beyond the semester scope.

1.3 Intended Use

The development team shall use this document as the basis for system design, implementation, and test-case creation. The instructor shall use it to evaluate whether the delivered system meets the specified scope. Requirements marked as functional shall be directly traceable to implemented features and demonstrated at project defense.

1.4 Product Scope

BashaMate is a new web application (not an extension of an existing product) that addresses a well-documented housing problem in Bangladesh: many landlords refuse to rent to unmarried ('bachelor') tenants, and students in particular struggle to find housing near their universities as a result. The platform allows landlords to list properties tagged by tenant-type preference, allows students to search and filter listings accordingly, and introduces a roommate-matching feature so that individual students can team up into a group landlords are more likely to accept. A verification layer (student ID, OTP, guardian contact) gives landlords a concrete reason to trust unfamiliar tenants. The objective is a functional, pilot-ready MVP scoped to a single city and university area within one academic semester.

1.5 Risk Definitions

The following risks have been identified and inform the requirements below:

- Trust risk: Landlords may distrust unverified student profiles, reducing platform adoption — mitigated by the verification and guardian-contact requirements (FR-1, FR-7).
- Fraud risk: Fake listings or fake student profiles could mislead users — mitigated by the reporting and admin-review requirements (FR-9).
- Privacy risk: Exposure of personal data (NID, phone numbers, guardian contact) could cause harm if mishandled — mitigated by the data-privacy non-functional requirement.

- Discrimination/liability risk: Publicly displaying tenant-type preferences could be perceived as facilitating discriminatory practices — the platform reflects existing landlord practice rather than creating it, and this should be acknowledged as a scope limitation rather than solved by the system.